Yet, that consensus has now unravelled totally. The BJP has been propounding the notion that 2014 was the year that India gained independence. And in many ways, the BJP has totally broken away from the painstakingly established consensus that successive governments built on from 1947 to 2014. It has abdicated its responsibilities to deliver on an inclusive social contract, responsive governance and adherence to the constitutional values of liberty, equality, fraternity and justice. Since 2014, things that were once unimaginable in our beloved India have become frequent occurrences. For instance, after one of the losses of the Indian cricket team, cricketer Mohammed Shami was referred to as a traitor and anti-nationalist, and was asked to go to Pakistan by right-wing extremists on social media. When the then Indian cricket team captain Virat Kohli came out in support of Mohammed Shami, even he and his wife Anushka Sharma were mercilessly attacked online. Similarly, right-wing extremists initiated a cyber attack against prominent actress Deepika Padukone because one of the attires she wore in a song sequence in one of her films was in the saffron colour. This was alleged to have been done deliberately to hurt religious sentiments. Instances such as these prove that the BJP has murdered our national soul.

Since 2014, any failure of the BJP government has been attempted to be covered up by an unrelated controversy or atrocity or distraction. This has been compounded a hundred-fold because of the complex crises that the Indian National Congress is suffering. It is creating grave problems for the nation. For years, Rahul Gandhi has been trying to correct the internal problems of the Congress in vain. He experimented with elections in the student and youth wings of the party, then primary elections to determine who the best candidate would be for elections. But for various reasons, things reached a stage where unless something revolutionary was done immediately, the damage to the Congress party (and consequently) our nation would have been beyond repair.

It is faced with these twin challenges that Rahul Gandhi decided to do the twelve-state Bharat Jodo Yatra, spanning a distance of more than 4,000 kilometres in over 150 days. Even though the Yatra was planned as well as